

LIVING ON CREDITS

COMPANY **Greenko** | WHAT THEY DO **Produce Renewable Energy** | TURNOVER **Rs 21 crore**

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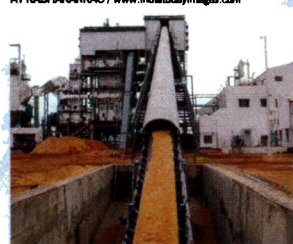


ANIL CHALAMALASETTY (LEFT)
WITH MAHESH KOLI

It's hard to imagine anyone making money out of agricultural waste, but that's precisely what Mahesh Koli and his partner Anil Chalamalasetty are doing. Founded in 2006, Greenko collects agricultural waste from food processing companies and sugar mills and converts it into clean power, which essentially means that power generated from biomass does not burn fossil fuels and thereby does not emit carbon dioxide into the atmosphere. In a short span of three years of its operation, the company is one of the largest players in the renewable energy market in India, with six small biomass plants and several other small hydro projects spread across the country. The biomass plants take the agricultural waste and burn it to create steam, and the power generated from that is put into the grid.

Greenko is currently putting 42 MW from its biomass plants into the national power grid and 60 MW from small hydro plants. Another 200 MW capacity is underway. The company claims that it is selling power to the state electricity boards for Rs 3.50 per unit, whereas the going rate is Rs 8.50 a unit. Not only does the company earn money by selling power but it also earns carbon credits after having reduced 30,000 tonnes of carbon, which it can sell in the international markets. So it's a win-win situation.

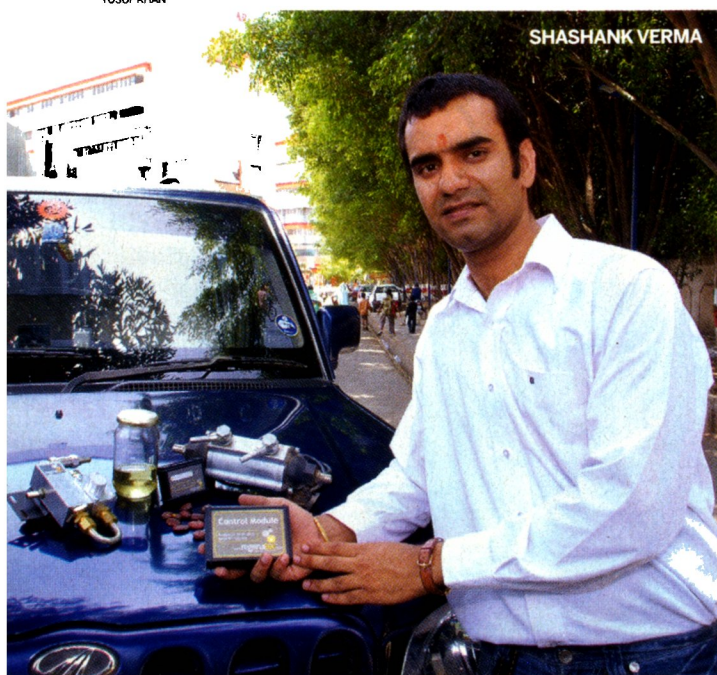
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CATALYSING CONVERSIONS

COMPANY **Regenastar** | WHAT THEY DO **Manufacturing Conversion Kits for Generators and Engines** | TURNOVER **N.A.**

YUSUF KHAN



SHASHANK VERMA

In Oxford while studying for an MBA, Shashank Verma and Sagun Saxena worked on a project on biofuels and were excited by its prospects. When they returned to India, the duo started a company to promote sustainable biofuel production but there were not many takers. Instead of changing the whole energy cycle, they decided to set up Regenastar, a company that offers technological assistance to help generator sets and engines using diesel to function on biofuels.

Regenastar's kit is like a CNG kit that can sit on top of an existing diesel engine or genset. Once fitted with that equipment, the genset or engine can run on biofuel, produced from any plant oil. An added advantage is that even used cooking oil can be used to power these kits. Essentially, this technology would enable a farmer to run his tractor on oil produced through his farm products. All that is required on the farmer's part is an investment of Rs 45,000 to Rs 90,000. Currently, the company is in talks with several companies that are big guzzlers of diesel to run pilots on their large generators.

with Amarnath K. Menon and Aditi Pal